

LUSH

This little thingamajig is one of the few salacious devices out there that not only syncs with smartphones but even the Apple Watch. Talk about progress! It syncs with an app over bluetooth and can be controlled over short and long distances with incredible variety (we know, we saw the demo video). You can program patterns, control intensity, and for whatever reason have the vibrations sync with the beats of your favourite song! Brings all new meaning to "loving your music" doesn't it?



That little tail there is the bluetooth antenna.

Being on dating platforms is almost a social necessity now, rather than a personal choice – at least in geek circles. People boast about their success on Tinder, for example. According to numbers released by Tinder themselves, from 2015 saw a 400% growth over 2014 in terms of the number of women users on the app in India. A lot of this is attributed to peer pressure. It's almost criminal to not be on social media, or else you get labelled a weirdo! Doesn't matter if you live a fulfilling and busy life, if it's not being displayed on social media, it's not being lived.

Another interesting development about the use of dating apps is the data from an American Sociology Review paper suggests that while the overall partnership rates of heterosexual couples has stayed the same, the partnership rate for same sex couples has skyrocketed. Apps give them opportunities to connect that they didn't have before.

SILENT LOVE STORIES

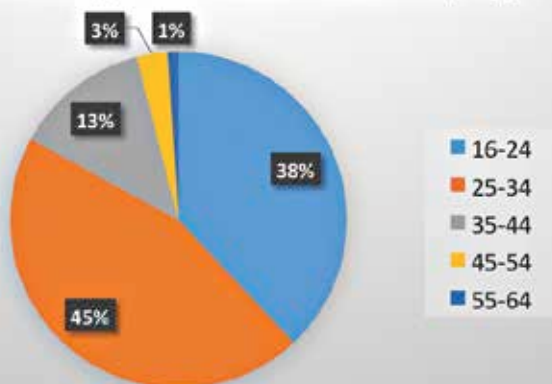
Let's leave the apps and sites behind for a bit. A more intrinsic change has been in our nature and habits due to technology. For example, texting is now a much more socially acceptable way of communicating over calling. According to a Text Request survey in June 2014, we send at least 561 billion text messages every month – that's roughly 200,000 text messages every second. Viewed in terms of couples courting, why not? Would you prefer to be put on the spot and have to answer questions about yourself, or would you rather have the time to formulate a decent answer? Modern couples can sometimes go days without talking to each other properly, while being actively loquacious over WhatsApp. And is that necessarily bad? So long as you get the point across and have a conversation, does it matter if it's not in

person, or using your voice? Plus, there are no awkward silences, no making up stuff to talk about when you run out of things to say, texting just pauses when one or both parties get busy, and that's the norm. Millennials would prefer this any day over having to dealing with the nuances of emotion. Though, it's not like millennials, the generation most into texting, is falling behind in expressing affection.

"With technology, PDA seems to have become quite common", says Divya Srivastava, consulting psychologist from Mumbai, "While many people cringe at extreme public displays of affection when it happens in front of them, the same thing when they see in the form of photos or videos on Facebook, Snapchat, Instagram, they go 'aww'. In general, I think the millennials are more okay with displaying love than the previous generations"

Although, it is very common to see texting being used as an escape mechanism in modern relationships. Breaking up over texts is a major, and quite serious, problem that today's couples, or rather, partners have to face. As Divya puts it, "I have clients who mention they never got closure because partners ended things over a text message, not wanting to meet or receive calls and then they are blocked from social media etc., and have no access and there are no further explanations given". She also adds "In some ways, technology has made people slightly irresponsible because unpleasant confrontations, no matter how uneasy, sometimes still need to be made at times....avoidance behaviours are easier now thanks to technology."

Percentage of Tinder Users by Age



The largest section of Tinder users comes from the 16-24 age group

CONNECTED COUPLES

Technology has been a boon to long distance relationships. In fact, we could go as far as saying modern day long distance relationships exist because of technology. With high quality video calls and VoIP calls becoming something we take for granted – you're always connected to your significant other. "Smart phones and tech changed our lives of course. Being in a long distance relationship for the last four years, I couldn't be more thankful", says Sociology student Sharanya